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PALM HILL

• L I N K •

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**Issue 11
49th Year**

**Couples Golf Celebrates Milestone
Story, Page 2**



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PALM HILL LINK

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The full-color digital version of the LINK is scheduled to be posted on the Palm Hill website on the first of each month – palmhillcountryclub.net. (Go to ABOUT tab at the top of the Home Page. (Editions posted go back to 2014.)

CONTACT THE LINK AT: LINKPALMHILL@GMAIL.COM

ALL CONTENT must be submitted to linkpalmhill@gmail.com for editorial review.

Changes, updates or cancellations to submitted items must be sent to linkpalmhill@gmail.com by the **10th** of each month, for the following month's edition (earlier for end-of-year holiday months). Submissions/listings will be prioritized and posted subject to space and editorial considerations. Submitters should include name and contact information.

CALENDAR in center of the LINK: Send submissions to the webmaster at palmhill.webmaster1@gmail.com. The LINK centerfold calendar is what is posted on the website calendar as of the Link's deadline. The website calendar is up-to-date.

GOING STRONG: COUPLES GOLF GROUP CELEBRATES 17-YEAR HISTORY

By Carolyn Story with Mac McElhinney

Couples Golf began in 2008, 17 years ago during the “Yes/No” history of Palm Hill. This was a contentious time when a proposal to purchase “The Park” from the Taylor Family divided shareholders.

Longtime Palm Hill resident and golfer Mac McElhinney recalled that within the Bandits golfing group, it got to a point that the “Yesses” and “Nos” sat separately on the Pro Shop porch in the morning, not even speaking to each other.

Mac came up with the thought that playing golf could alleviate this somewhat and get longtime friends past this uncomfortable situation and speak to each other again.

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*Pictured: Carolyn Flaherty and Mac McElhinney, founders of Couples Golf.
Photo by Lois Marshall.*

Mac and Carolynn Flaherty's original plan was to play at East Bay Golf Course but that was changed to Palm Hill since everyone had a membership here. Everyone gathered afterward for dinner at 4 p.m. at Cody's Restaurant in Largo. Wednesday was the day chosen because Cody's offered two-for-one fajitas that day.

The rules were:

1. You could talk about politics.
2. You could talk about religion.
3. You could talk about sports.
4. YOU COULD NOT TALK ABOUT PALM HILL.

The original group consisted of Mac McElhinney and Carolynn Flaherty (in photo), Fred and Norma Ashwell, E.R. and Ruth Vissman, Phil and Rhoda Magistro, Herb and Mary Leslie and Richie and Carolyn Story.



Mac McElhinney and
Carolynn Flaherty
Photo by Lois Marshall

Originally, teams were selected by placing the names in a bag and then selecting randomly. However, as time went on, and Couples Golf grew in numbers, teams were assigned by those volunteering to take charge of the pairings. They never imagined during the formative years that this event would expand in popularity and interest to the numbers involved today. In mid-winter as many as 100 to 120 people play golf together in scramble format on Thursday mornings. (Sign-up is available at the Pro Shop.)

Couples Golf 17th Anniversary Event

Eighty-four golfers, plus some former "Couples" golfers who can no longer play golf, attended the December 4 celebration, which was sponsored by Jim and Sandy Jones, Carolyn Story and Howard Sneed, and Terri and Sean MacGilvray, who all donated the food. Volunteers who also donated condiments and did the cooking: Randy Mitchell, Jeff Wesolowski and Tom "Pickles" Locher.

Today's "Couples" golfers thanked and celebrated Mac and Carolynn for initiating "Couples Golf" with the intent to bring friends back to the core and realize that differences of opinions are acceptable behavior and continuous friendship and respect are paramount in all relationships.



Cake for 17th Anniversary,
Couples Golf
Photo by Terri MacGilvray

FROM THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS

From Henry Klain President, HOPH, Inc.

As we welcome the New Year, may Palm Hill continue to be a community marked by kindness, connection, and a shared sense of home. Wishing everyone health, happiness, and renewed energy for the year ahead.

On behalf of the Board of Directors,

HAPPY NEW YEAR TO ALL!